

Digital Safety for College Students • Facilitator Guide

The Hackles Kit

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

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Hackles · Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell. A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org. Hackles College Edition, Part B.

TO VERIFY

Status: DRAFT for campus review. Blanks in [BRACKETS] are for your college to fill in. [VERIFY] marks a fact to check against a primary source. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] marks a legal or policy point that your counsel, Title IX coordinator or student-affairs leadership must review before use. This guide is educational and is not legal advice.

01 What this is

DIGITAL SAFETY FOR COLLEGE Students is six 50-minute sessions for people aged about 17 to 24. Each session works alone, so you can run one at orientation or all six across a term, and the same material runs as a one-day workshop (Section 4).

It's built for first-year seminars, orientation, student success courses, residence life programming and student clubs. It's built for community colleges too. It costs nothing to run, it needs only a projector and paper, and the cards and slides work in an evening class, a commuter-student lunch hour or a hallway in a residence hall.

No student accounts. No student data collected, ever. The evaluation card is anonymous and you tally counts only.

The six sessions

#	SESSION	CORE TOPICS
1	Too Good, Too Fast: Scams Aimed at Students	Fake jobs and internships, housing and rental scams, financial-aid and tuition phishing, textbook and ticket scams
2	Locks You Will Actually Use	Password managers, 2-step, passkeys, recovery, SIM-swap defence, campus Wi-Fi and shared devices
3	Your Footprint	Location, app permissions, data brokers, job-search footprint
4	Is It Real?	Synthetic media, voice cloning, verification habits, generative AI and academic integrity
5	When Pictures Are Used Against You	Sextortion, romance scams, image-based abuse, StopNCII for adults, supporting a friend
6	Control, Harassment and Upstanders	Online stalking and harassment, relationship coercion, bystander moves, where to get help locally

Each session file has objectives, prep, a facilitator script, an activity with fictional scenario cards, role-play practice, discussion, a takeaway, a disclosure protocol, accessibility notes, a local resource table and an anonymous evaluation card. A slide deck, with the script in the speaker notes, sits next to each session file.

The ground rules of the material

1. **Defence only.** Nothing in this module teaches how to attack, scam, stalk, trace, crack or surveil anyone. If a student asks, redirect to what a defender or a person at risk can do. For students interested in security careers, point to [CYBER CLUB OR PROGRAM].
2. **Fictional composites only.** No real student, case or screenshot is shown. Names such as Noor or Dario recur across sessions as a shared cast, and each card is a separate situation. Change any name that matches someone in your room.
3. **Nobody plays a victim or an offender.** Role-plays are verification calls, check-in lines and reply-writing. The "other voice" is a printed card, the facilitator, or a helpful office worker.
4. **Participation is always optional.** A Pass card is always available.
5. **No statistics are quoted in the script.** If you add one, cite the source and date, and mark it [VERIFY].
6. **Never promise confidentiality you can't give.** See Section 6.

02 Who should facilitate

GOOD FACILITATORS INCLUDE STUDENT affairs staff, counselors, residence life professionals, faculty who teach first-year courses, librarians, IT security staff and trained peer educators. Pairs work best: one faculty or staff member and one trained student peer.

Sessions 5 and 6 should have a counselor or advocate present or on call. If your college has no advocate, invite someone from [COUNSELING CENTER] or a local community partner [LOCAL].

Before facilitating, read:

- the Disclosure and Incident Guide in kit/05_Teacher_Support (written for K-12; read it for tone and the First 10 Minutes habits, and then use Section 6 of this guide for adult contexts);
- the Train the Trainer Guide in kit/12_Facilitator_Kit;
- your college's policies on sexual misconduct, stalking, harassment, student conduct and academic integrity.

03 Four-week preparation timeline

WHEN	TASK	OWNER
4 weeks before	Choose the format (Section 4) and the audience. Book the room, projector and a quiet room for after the session.	Coordinator
4 weeks before	Meet [COUNSELING CENTER], [TITLE IX OFFICE] and [CAMPUS POLICE]. Ask three questions: Which of you can keep information confidential? Who is a responsible employee? What happens when a student walks in? Write the answers in Section 6. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]	Coordinator
3 weeks before	Fill in the local blanks (Appendix A) and the Campus Safety Card. Ask [IT HELP DESK] and [FINANCIAL AID OFFICE] the questions at the top of each session's prep list.	Facilitator
2 weeks before	Print cards, safety cards and evaluation cards. Send slide decks to disability services if a student has requested advance materials.	Facilitator
1 week before	Run through the script aloud. Time it. Read the session's disclosure notes again.	Facilitator and co-facilitator
Day of	Arrive 20 minutes early. Check the projector, captions and room layout. Put the counselor's location on the first slide for Sessions 5 and 6.	Facilitator
After	Tally the evaluation cards (counts only). Debrief with a supervisor if anyone disclosed. Record only what policy requires.	Facilitator

04 Formats

4.1 SIX SESSIONS ACROSS A TERM (RECOMMENDED FOR FIRST-YEAR SEMINARS AND STUDENT SUCCESS COURSES)

ONE SESSION A WEEK for six weeks, in the same room at the same time.
Session 5 benefits from a week of trust building first, so put it in week 4 or 5.

4.2 ONE-DAY WORKSHOP (ABOUT 6.5 HOURS INCLUDING LUNCH)

TIME	SEGMENT	NOTES
9:00 to 9:15	Welcome, agreements, the Hackles routine	Read the heads-up on privacy and reporting [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
9:15 to 10:05	Session 1	Run the 50-minute session without the opening five minutes if you have just welcomed the group
10:05 to 10:20	Break	
10:20 to 11:10	Session 2	Students bring phones and chargers
11:10 to 12:00	Session 3	
12:00 to 12:45	Lunch	Offer a quiet room
12:45 to 1:35	Session 4	Invite a faculty member or integrity officer for the last 10 minutes
1:35 to 1:50	Break	Counselor arrives
1:50 to 2:40	Session 5	Counselor or advocate in the room
2:40 to 2:55	Break and reset	A walk, a stretch, a snack. Do not skip this
2:55 to 3:45	Session 6	Finish with the resource map
3:45 to 4:00	Close	Pledge card, evaluation, Campus Safety Card

If you must shorten the day, drop Session 3 or fold Session 4's AI section into a course visit. Do not shorten Session 5 or 6.

4.3 SHORT FORMATS

FORMAT	USE	PLAN
50 minutes at orientation	Large group, one chance	Session 1 with the Campus Safety Card and a 5-minute walk through the resource table
Residence life floor meeting (30 minutes)	RAs and peer educators	Session 1 cards, then the RA quick guide
Two-session club series	Cyber, education and honor-society clubs	Session 2 and Session 4
Evening class (3 sessions in 3 weeks)	Community college evening cohort	Sessions 1, 2 and 6
Self-paced online	Commuter students	Slides with notes plus the printable cards; a discussion board with a facilitator [LOCAL: confirm accessibility and privacy settings]

05 Community college and commuter notes

- **Time.** Many students arrive from work or leave for childcare. Start and end on time. Provide a one-page handout (the Campus Safety Card) so students who miss a session still get the key point.
- **Cost.** Print in black and white. Cards can be projected instead of printed. Skip printed slide decks.
- **Evening and weekend.** Make sure the counseling center's hours match your session times, or give the after-hours route (988, Crisis Text Line, [AFTER-HOURS CAMPUS NUMBER]).
- **Dual-enrollment and under-18 students.** A student under 18 may be in the room. Reporting duties differ, and content such as Session 5 may need a different handling plan [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]. Use the K-12 9-12 Teacher Guide for any group where the students are minors.
- **International and multilingual students.** See the inclusion notes in each session. Where possible, offer bilingual facilitators or translated cards reviewed by language faculty [LOCAL].

06 Disclosure: the master protocol for adults

SESSIONS 5 AND 6 are likely to prompt a student to tell someone about something real, and Sessions 1 to 4 sometimes do too. Adult students are entitled to make their own choices. Their disclosures differ from K-12 ones, because the student usually decides whether to report and you have different duties.

Before you facilitate, find out which of these you are [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM; VERIFY current federal rules, state law and your college's policy]:

ROLE	WHAT YOU CAN PROMISE	FILL IN LOCALLY
Confidential resource (for example, licensed counselor, health clinician, sometimes an advocate or chaplain)	Confidentiality, with limits set by law, such as imminent danger or abuse of a minor	[WHO COUNTS AS CONFIDENTIAL AT THIS COLLEGE]
Responsible employee or mandatory reporter on campus	You must share certain information with the Title IX office and cannot promise confidentiality	[WHO IS A RESPONSIBLE EMPLOYEE HERE]
Peer educator or student employee	Check with the Title IX office; many colleges treat student staff, such as RAs, as reporting employees	[STATUS OF PEER EDUCATORS HERE]
Mandated reporter of child abuse	You may have separate state duties to report child abuse or a minor in an exploitative image	[STATE LAW; VERIFY]

Open every session with a heads-up (it is in each script). Students deserve to know before they speak.

The steps

1. Say the heads-up first: "Before you go on, I want to tell you what I can and cannot keep private."
2. Listen and believe. "Thank you for telling me. This is not your fault."
3. Do not investigate. Do not ask to see messages or images. Do not contact the other person.
4. Never promise confidentiality or outcomes you cannot give.
5. Offer choices. Counseling, an advocate, the Title IX office, campus police, a platform report, or nothing today.
6. Make a warm handoff. Offer to walk or sit with them.
7. Safety first. Immediate danger: 911 or [CAMPUS POLICE]. Suicidal thoughts: stay with the student; 988 (call or text 988; chat at 988lifeline.org); Crisis Text Line (text HOME to 741741).
8. If a minor is involved (for example, an image made when the student was under 18), follow your reporting duties [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM; VERIFY state law]. Do not copy or forward the image.
9. Write down the student's words and your actions as policy requires. Share on a need-to-know basis.
10. Debrief with your supervisor and look after yourself.

What you will say about reporting. Choose the line that matches your status and put it on a card.

- If you are a confidential resource: "What you tell me stays between us, except in a few situations such as imminent danger or abuse of a minor [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM wording]."
- If you are a responsible employee: "If you tell me about something that falls under our sexual misconduct policy, I must tell the Title IX coordinator. They will contact you about support and options. You will not be forced into any process. If you would like to talk privately first, [COUNSELING CENTER] can help." [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM wording]

07 Evaluation

USE THE ANONYMOUS EVALUATION card at the end of each session. Collect two things: the number of students who circle each rating, and a list of improvement suggestions. Don't collect names, student IDs or emails. Aggregate counts go to your supervisor as part of your regular report, and individual cards are recycled after tallying [LOCAL: confirm records policy].

If you want to track change over a term, use the same two circle questions at Session 1 and Session 6, with a blank card each time, and report only counts. Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled study, so don't claim that it prevents harm.

08 Troubleshooting

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
A student says "this is overblown, nobody falls for this."	Agree that most people spot most scams. Add that attackers need only one miss, and that skilled and careful people are caught when tired or rushed. Move to the card.
A student asks how to do the attack in the card.	"This module is about defence. If you are interested in the security field, here is [CYBER CLUB OR PROGRAM]." Do not give technique.
A student tells you they are being scammed right now.	Move the activity aside. Use the first-hour list in Session 1. Offer a quiet space. Call the bank together if the student wishes.
A student discloses in front of the group.	Interrupt kindly: "Thank you. Let's talk about this in a moment, just us." Move on, and speak after class with the heads-up.
Someone jokes about a heavy card.	Name it calmly. "Some of this lands hard for people. We will keep it respectful." Offer a break.
The room is quiet.	Use the written question box, pair talk and a show of hands. Do not call on individuals.
A student is angry at the college.	Acknowledge the feeling, and note that you will pass on feedback. Do not argue policy.

09 Optional extras from the Hackles kit

The Concepts Lab (kit/13_Concepts_Lab) has short, adult-friendly demos you can borrow: Demo 03 Anatomy of a Phish, Demo 08 Social Engineering Defense, Demo 09 Data Footprints and Data Brokers, Demo 12 Spot the Fake. Check each one for your audience's age first. They were written for a broad audience.

10 The Hackles routine for adults

SEE THE COMPANION HANDOUT "Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell." for adults in this folder. The short version: notice the prickle, give it a few minutes, check through a door you opened yourself, and tell a person. A false alarm is fine. If you were fooled anyway, it is never your fault.

Appendix A: Local blanks master list

Fill in once and reuse across the module.

BLANK	YOUR ANSWER
[COLLEGE NAME]	
[CAMPUS POLICE EMERGENCY NUMBER] and [CAMPUS POLICE NON-EMERGENCY NUMBER]	
[COUNSELING CENTER] name, phone, location, hours	
[TITLE IX OFFICE] name, email, phone	
[VICTIM ADVOCATE] if any	
[DEAN OF STUDENTS] or student affairs	
[FINANCIAL AID OFFICE] and [BURSAR]	
[HOUSING OFFICE] and [RESIDENCE LIFE]	
[CAREER SERVICES]	
[IT HELP DESK] and [IT SECURITY]	
[INTERNATIONAL STUDENT OFFICE]	
[DISABILITY SERVICES]	
[ACADEMIC INTEGRITY OFFICE]	
[OFFICIAL NETWORK NAME]	
[CAMPUS SAFE EXCHANGE SPOT] if any	
[EMERGENCY AID OR BASIC NEEDS OFFICE] if any	
[CAMPUS LGBTQ+ CENTER] if any	
[AFTER-HOURS CAMPUS NUMBER]	

The national resources table is on the Campus Safety Card and at the bottom of each session file.

Appendix B: Say this, not that

SAY	INSTEAD OF
"Thank you for telling me."	"Why did you send it?"
"This is not your fault."	"You should have known."
"What do you need right now?"	"Let me see it."
"I am not sure. Let's ask [OFFICE]."	Making something up
"Here is what I can and cannot keep private."	"I'll keep this between us."
"You decide what to do next."	"You have to report this."
"A false alarm is fine."	"That was silly."

Appendix C: Content note and group agreements (read aloud)

"Some of what we cover can touch real experiences. You can pass on any activity and you can step out and come back. We will not ask anyone to share a personal story. We use made-up examples. We treat each other with respect, and we do not repeat personal things people say here. I will tell you what I cannot keep private. If anything is hard for you, [COUNSELING CENTER] is at [LOCATION] and I will walk you there."

Note: asking a group to keep things private cannot guarantee anyone will. Say "we ask" and not "we promise."

Appendix D: What this module does not do

HACKLES HAS NOT BEEN evaluated in a controlled study. It is not therapy, legal advice, a Title IX training, a security certification or a substitute for your college's processes. It gives students habits, words and a map of local help.

Sources: Hackles 9-12 Teacher Guide (threat modelling, credentials, social engineering, data brokers, sextortion response, synthetic media, coercion online), Disclosure and Incident Guide, Facilitator Kit, Concepts Lab and the Round 3 verification files for hotline details.